

GRADE 3 •

Scientific Inquiry in Life Science

Ask. Look closely. Discover!

READY, SCIENTISTS?



Let's Explore!

You can perform simple investigations by observing, predicting, and measuring to learn about the natural world!

Why does a plant grow toward sunlight?

Why do animals behave differently in different places?





What Is Scientific Inquiry?

Scientific inquiry means learning about the natural world by asking questions, observing, predicting, gathering information, and using evidence.

1 ASK

2 PREDICT

3 OBSERVE

4 MEASURE

5 RECORD

6 EXPLAIN

SKILL 1

Observing

Observing means using your senses or tools to gather information.

Example: Look closely at the leaves of a plant.





SKILL 2

Predicting

Predicting means making a reasonable guess about what may happen.

Example: I predict a plant near sunlight will grow well.

SKILL 3

Measuring

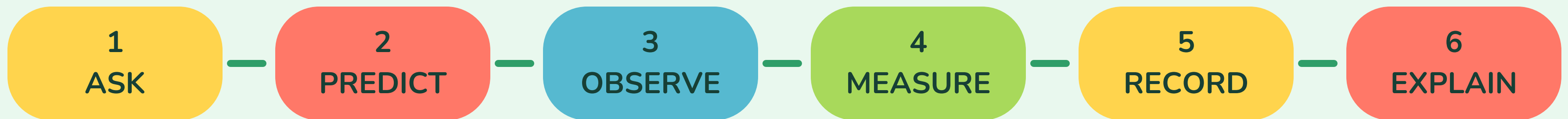
Measuring means using tools or standard units to find out size or amount.

Example: Use a ruler to measure how tall a plant is — in centimeters (cm).



Steps of a Simple Investigation

Question: Does a plant grow taller over time?



Prediction: It will grow taller.

- Observe each day.
- Measure with a ruler.
- Record the height.
- Explain what the evidence shows.

Watch a Plant Grow!

DAY 1 • 3 cm

DAY 2 • 5 cm

DAY 3 • 8 cm

DAY 4 • 12 cm



We observe and measure the plant every day to see how it grows.

Young Scientist Challenge!

Shout it out: Observing, Predicting, or Measuring?

ANA

Ana looks closely at a flower.

BEN

Ben says the seed will grow into a plant.

CARLO

Carlo uses a ruler to measure a leaf.

DANA

Dana records the number of leaves on a plant.

ELLA

Ella guesses the plant will grow taller next week.

Quick Check!

1. What skill gathers information using our senses?
A Predicting B Observing C Guessing D Drawing
 2. What do we do when we say what we think will happen?
A Measuring B Predicting C Recording D Comparing
 3. Which tool can measure plant height?
A Ruler B Spoon C Plate D Pencil case
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4. Why do scientists record observations and measurements?
A Decorate B Keep evidence C Make it longer D Avoid questions
 5. Which sequence shows a simple investigation?
A Ask → Predict → Observe → Measure
B Measure → Sleep → Predict → Ask
C Draw → Play → Ask → Sleep
D Guess → Stop → Measure → Forget



Answer Key

Great thinking, scientist!

- 1 • B — Observing
- 2 • B — Predicting
- 3 • A — Ruler
- 4 • B — Keep evidence
- 5 • A — Ask → Predict → Observe → Measure



You Are a Young Scientist!

- Ask questions to learn about the world.
- Observe to gather information.
- Predict what might happen.
- Measure with tools and units.
- Use evidence to explain.

Keep exploring and discovering the amazing natural world!

